

Create an Electronics Product Using sPlan

sPlan Windows based electronic design automation tool (EDA) is one of the least-complicated software available for developing circuit schematics, and thus a great choice for getting started with circuit design

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SPlan is a complex EDA tool with a straightforward user interface (UI) that lets you design schematics for electronics and electrical circuits. The user can design entry-level to complex schematics with the neatness, precision and accuracy comparable with professional designs.

Why use sPlan

This software is free from several unwanted and complicated functions, thereby giving it a user-friendly and simple (though a little old-fashioned) structure. Features like drag-and-drop of components into the user-definable grid and exact fitting of these components on the grid make it suitable even for newcomers and people with no solid background in the field of electronics designs. Well-defined, easy and intuitive to handle are the main characteristics that make sPlan better than other similar schematic editor tools.

An extensive, well-sorted library of electronic components comes with the package and is found on the left panel of the home screen. There are two default libraries—standard and user. The standard library contains a variety of components like resistors, inductors, capacitors, diodes, connectors, meters, grounds, transistors, batteries, microphones and power supplies. You can drag-and-drop the required symbol/component into the workspace and it will be positioned exactly on the grid. Apart from this, the user

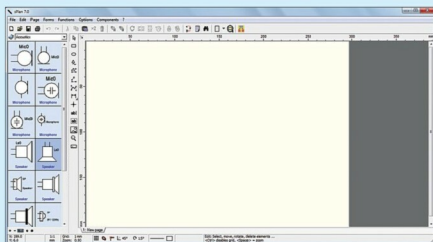


Fig. 1: Home

can copy components, create new components, delete new or existing components, and reorganise existing libraries or create new libraries according to the requirement.

With sPlan, the user can not only create professional-grade circuit schematics but also preview and adjust the print layouts, and get high-quality prints of these schematics. You can print a single page, selected range of pages or all the pages in a project. There is also a banner-printing function in the latest release, which lets you print schematics spread over multiple pages. For example, an A3-size schematic can be printed on two A4-size sheets. The company also provides a freeware called sPlan 7.0—a viewer that lets you open, view and print files created using sPlan in best quality. On installation of sPlan, the viewer tool

Software tools

Licence type	Shareware (demo version)
Developer	Lothar Feldmann and Matthias Prüssel, ABACOM
Latest version	7.0
File size	4.8MB
Experience level	Beginners, intermediates and hobbyists

is either available in its installation directory or can be downloaded directly from the ABACOM website.

Some sPlan features

There are several features of sPlan that make it fast, flexible and simple.

Pages. Large circuit diagrams often need to be divided into sub-circuits or modules so that the project becomes less complicated. sPlan allows the creation of as many pages as you want in each project so you can create each